



**LEARNING CURVE:**  
Xavier's, Kolkata, which has made it to the second spot, focuses on activity

secured the second rank, new departments, extensive multimedia set-ups and a Rs 70-lakh-well-equipped mass media laboratory are being added. With the dream of becoming a full-fledged university, St. Xavier's College campus is abuzz with activity. "Classes are exciting. Visuals, through projectors and computers, enhance lessons. It's much better than the chalk-and-talk method," explains Sharbari Sinha, a second-year student of microbiology. Multimedia is the buzzword in the science classes now, and teachers are paid extra incentive if they digitalise their courses.

**S**tudents have always flocked to St. Xavier's to study arts and commerce. But some great new subjects and state-of-the-art facilities have ensured in the last few years that science subjects are no less sought after. Apart from the age-old subjects like physics, chemistry and biology, there are new draws like microbiology and biotechnology. Also, post-graduate courses in computer science and astrophysics are in the offing. Computer science saw 23 out of its 31 students getting placements

## FROM THE PRINCIPAL



**"We have arranged for multimedia setups to make the classes more interactive."**

FR. P.C. MATHEW, ST. XAVIER'S, KOLKATA

last year. The college recently tied up with IBM where it will give training to the company's fresh recruits. They will get an MS degree from Mysore University.

Meanwhile, St. Xavier's College, Ahmedabad, which is at the third position in the survey, has built a repu-

tation for the scientific research conducted at the undergraduate level. Students in the science departments are encouraged to take up guided research projects from the undergraduate level, mainly in bio-sciences, and 10 students are selected every year for guided research projects. At the end of every year, the projects are evaluated and students are awarded scholarships on merit. "We got an A-plus when we went for re-accreditation recently from NAAC," says Father Francis Parmar, principal of the college, adding, the NAAC team made a special note of the college's research work in diverse areas such as DNA finger printing, plasma and polymer research, ozone and atmospheric science, neutron star, particle physics and nanotechnology.

"One more thing that marks out the college is its humane approach. We have two full-time teachers as counsellors who work on students who have psychological problems," says Father Parmar. As the college has proved, cutting-edge science with a gentle, humane approach can be a formidable combination.

**with Uday Mahurkar in Ahmedabad and Swagata Sen in Kolkata**